

PROJECTORS BECOMING MORE CAPABLE

Today's projectors are small, light and bright. These are also more interactive, network-capable and 3D-ready and more. While projectors smaller than laptops are quite common today, soon cellphone-sized projectors might also become mainstream. Let us take a look at these and other trends in the projection space



Hitachi CP-A100 LCD projector

■ JANANI GOPALAKRISHNAN
VIKRAM WITH INPUTS FROM
ONKAR SHARMA

At one point of time, the only medium for education delivery to students was the teacher's voice. Then came the ubiquitous blackboards and more sophisticated whiteboards. Over time, the education sector evolved into a high-tech segment, thanks to the extensive use of computers, projectors, and other content creation and delivery aids. Today, the education sector is the largest consumer of projectors. Other eager takers include the IT-enabled services (ITES), business process outsourcing organisations, call centres, healthcare

providers, other businesses and even home users. Wherever there is a need to present information in multimedia, or where design and visuals play a key role, a projector is indispensable.

"A market that is generating much interest as a part of and by the virtue of video is the projector market. The market gained considerable momentum in financial year 2009 as close to 76,000 units of projectors were sold during the year," says Mohammed Nasir, manager-marketing at Canon India.

Two of the largest buyers of projectors are the education and ITES/BPO segments. "A 1000-seater call centre would require anywhere between 15 and 30 projectors as an instructional tool for training new employees. With

prices having dropped by over 50 per cent over the last three years, many corporate buyers are today opting for more than one projector for their organisation," he adds. Even the home front is showing a lot of promise, with vendors targeting the upwardly mobile and techno-savvy professionals. Around 12 per cent of the projector market is now dominated by home-use products.

Overall, the demand for projectors is on the rise. The market is displaying a 13-15 per cent growth world over. In India, it is expected to grow at over 25 per cent compound annual growth rate (CAGR) over the next three years. As a result, most vendors are now pushing their products very actively in the Indian market. More products with innovative features are making an entry.

The current generation of projectors is characterised by high resolution, extraordinary brightness, ultra-portability, low maintenance requirements, long life, energy efficiency, interactivity, networkability (including wireless) as well as high-definition video and 3D capabilities, amongst other cutting-edge features. This article provides a quick overview of these and other technological enhancements in the field of projectors.

The little hares: Small yet smart

"The excellent price performance of mainstream projectors today is well